BREEDING GROUNDS

Apart from Janwal (Latur), breeders in Paranda(Osmanabad) and Baramati, near Pune, are also trying to propagate the Pashmi and Caravan



₹2.5 lakh
Average income earned by the dog breeders of Janwal

₹15,000
Average price of a puppy

3 months
Average breeding season for the Caravan

50
No. of dog breeders in Janwal and Mhalangi

stacked with sacks of soyabean and jowar. With the first spells of rain, sowing for the kharif season will start. But as farmers across India worry if inflation could force up prices of fertilisers and pesticides, Pawar isn't that concerned about his 'cash in hand' for such farming essentials. 'Malhar', his pet dog of the Pashmi breed, took care of that.

Pawar charges Rs 5,000 from villagers who bring their female Pashmis for breeding with Malhar. As a purebred stud, Malhar contributes Rs 2-2.5 lakh to Pawar's household annually. The breeding season starts from Dussehra and lasts till Diwali. "The money I earn from breeding covers almost 25 per cent of farming expenses, such as labour charges. That has reduced my dependency on bank loans," says Pawar, who is in his 40s, heads a family of four and owns 45 acres of farm land.

Similar tales of dog-breeding entrepreneurship among some 50 families in Janwal and the nearby village of Mhalangi are rewriting

BOTH THE PASHMI AND THE CARAVAN ARE SIGHT HOUNDS, DOGS WHO HUNT BY SIGHT RATHER THAN SCENT. THEY ARE IN HUGE DEMAND NOW AS GUARD DOGS

Latur's reputation as a bone-dry district—in 2016, it hit national headlines when drinking water had to be transported there in railway wagons from Sangli, over 300 kilometres away. (Water-hungry sugarcane, however, has made a comeback on the strength of two normal monsoons.)

Janwal and its surrounding areas are known for the breeding of the Pashmi as well as the Caravan dog. The latter looks much like the Pashmi—the same long muzzle, the rippling muscles in the same lean body, but without the Pashmi's lightly feathered coat. Innate hunters and guard dogs, both are 'sight hounds'—dogs who hunt by sight rather than by scent. Caravans, they say, are as fast as light. The magnificent spectacle of these lithe crea-